

Blockade before attacking a passer

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

A passed pawn cannot be stopped by an enemy pawn on its file or adjacent files ahead of it. Blocking it can prevent promotion and limit the support it receives. A knight often makes a useful blockader because it can attack while sitting directly in front.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A knight on d6 in front of a white pawn on d5 stops its advance while influencing nearby squares. The blockade becomes fragile if White can chase or exchange that knight, so support the blockading square.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should the side with the passed pawn try to do?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Challenge the blockader, create a second threat, or use the pawn's restriction to improve other pieces. Pushing the pawn is only one way to benefit from it.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

First immobilize the passer; then organize pressure on it.